

COMMUNITY LIFE



Monumental ceremony

John Dunn (above), a survivor of the great Almonte train wreck, examines the names of the 39 lives lost as a result of the horrifying railway accident that took place in 1942. The names are inscribed on a brand new monument dedicated to the wreck and an official unveiling ceremony for the monument was held last Wednesday, Dec. 27, 58 years to the day of the accident. Herb Pragnell (right), chair of the Almonte Train Wreck Committee of the North Lanark Historical Society spoke at the event. Photo by Phil Ambroziak

The story of a train wreck survivor

Jessie Florence (Penney) Bouckaert survived collision

By Wes Bomhower
Special to the Gazette

Born on a farm in September 1909 at Kilmaurs in Torbolton Township, which is now a part of West Carleton, Jessie Florence Penney was one of seven children born to William Penney and Jane Gray. She attended grade school at S.S.#5 Torbolton, (it no longer exists) and graduated in 1922.

Time were hard for a large family, and she had to stay home for a year before enrolling at Arnprior High School in 1924-25. She then missed another year of schooling before finding a nurses' training school that would accept her with her limited education. At 18 years of age, Penney began training as a nurse at Nassau Hospital School of Nursing in Mineola, Long Island, USA. She graduated in 1930 and continued nursing at this same hospital until April 1941.

The Second World War was in progress and Penney moved to Ann Arbor, Michigan, where she nursed in the operating room of University of Michigan Hospital.

She came home to Torbolton Township for vacation in early December 1942, spent Christmas with family and friends and was returning by train to Michigan for the New Year. Penney boarded the train at Arnprior on December 27 after visiting with one of her sisters there. Fortunately, she was seated in the sixth coach from the rear of the train.

They pulled into Almonte, and as they sat in the station, a fast-moving troop train plowed into the rear of the passenger train. Penney herself was sent flying out of her seat and received a whiplash effect, which bothered her for many years later. The three rear coaches were demol-

ished by the impact and Penney remembers the scene being like a battleground. Many people were dead and mutilated, and others were terribly wounded. Penney was pressed into service and her training served her well until local nurses arrived on the scene. A hospital train was dispatched and morphine was administered to some of the worst cases. Doors were used as stretchers to carry the wounded.

It was a horrible night Penney has never forgotten. She and the remaining passengers did not reach Ottawa until 6 a.m. the next morning, so she rented a hotel room and continued on to Michigan the following day.

Penney continued her career at the University of Michigan and some years later met Paul Bouckaert, a tool and die maker for General Motors in Detroit. They were married in

August 1967 and she stayed on the nursing staff for a few more years. They lived in Ypsilanti, near Ann Arbor, until Bouckaert died in 1972.

She returned to Ontario in 1979 and stayed with her brother at Kilmaurs, now Woodlawn, for a year or two. She then came to Arnprior to care for her two sisters. Both passed away but she stayed on in the same house with her eldest niece, Amy Calberry, and she is still there.

She was never one to sit idle, so she obtained her high school diploma after retirement and also took up music, learning to play the accordion quite well. She is in reasonably good health for her 91 years and her niece says she has a mind like a computer — she had no children of her own, but can rattle off the birth and marriage dates of any relative at a moments' notice.

Museum treasurer appointed to CGA board

Alan Jones, FCGA, the treasurer of the Mississippi Valley Textile Museum and a member of the Valley Players, has recently been appointed to the Board of Governors of the Certified General Accountants' Association of Ontario.

Jones received his CGA in British Columbia in 1964, and during his career in Revenue Canada, was made a Fellow of the CGA

Association in 1992 and following retirement, a life member in 1996.

A dedicated community volunteer, Jones is currently serving as chair of the Ottawa-Carleton Rural Stewardship Council and as a member of the Local Architecture Conservation Advisory Committee (LACAC) for West Carleton, both organizations which will be amalga-

mated along with the new City of Ottawa.

Jones is also a founder and Fellow of the Canadian Institute of Chartered Business Valuators, which he served as president from 1984 to 1986.

The Certified General Accountants Association of Ontario is a self-governing body, which grants the exclusive right to the CGA designation and controls the

professional standards, conduct and disciplines of its members and students in the province of Ontario.

Certified General Accountants occupy key financial and management positions in business, industry, education and government. Additionally, as partners and owners of their own firms, many CGAs offer accounting and financial services to the public.

Make your home skunk-proof now

Your Watershed
Mississippi Valley Conservation

By Paul Lehman



It's amazing how some animals can adapt and thrive in urban environments. The availability of food and water combined with the absence of natural predators makes urban living quite attractive.

But what if one of those animals decides to make itself at home in or under your home? Sometimes human-wildlife contact do occur, and a little understanding of the animals' characteristics and needs will help you to take a humane approach to its removal. At Mississippi Valley Conservation, our aim is to find a good balance between wildlife requirements and human needs.

Skunks are excellent diggers that live in dens under porches, decks or sheds and are capable of digging a den a foot underground. They are nocturnal omnivores, feeding at night on plants, insects, bird eggs, fallen fruits as well as the smorgasbord that humans put out on garbage day. Skunks are not good climbers so cannot get into attics or chimneys.

A persistent skunk smell is a good indication that you have an uninvited guest. You should inspect around your foundation or deck for a small 10-25 centimetre hole. If you have found a hole and you want to see if it is active, then cover the hole with loose dirt and wait two or three days to see if the dirt has been dug out. You can also sprinkle flour around the entrance and watch for telltale footprints.

Before closing any entry hole permanently, make sure that all of the animals are out or they will die a slow and painful death, and will eventually cause a terrible odor as they decompose.

Once you are sure the den is empty, they you should cover the hole with galvanized steel screening because skunks will attempt to get back into their den. The removal of one family of skunks without fixing the den entrance will only create an opportunity for another skunk to make himself at home.

Live trapping and relocation have been widely used in the past, but this is not a long term solution. Studies have shown that relocated animals do not survive and can upset the natural balance at the relocation site and can cause the spread of disease from one location to another.

Now that the weather is getting colder, it is a good idea to inspect your home and outbuildings for potential entrances for skunks. Prevention of skunk problems through good property maintenance is the only permanent solution. For more information, call the Canadian Federation of Human Societies at 224-8072 or e-mail cfs@magi.com

Curl up with a good book

Pakenham Branch Mystery Library has these new books:
Code to Zero by Ken Follet - Best-seller
Prodigal Summer by Barbara Kingsolver - Best-seller
The Stanislawski Brothers by Nora Roberts - Romance
Christmas Cookie Murder by Lellie Meier - Mystery
Visit Pakenham Branch Library, near the arena, in Pakenham. The library is open: Tuesdays 2 to 4 p.m. and 7 to 9 p.m., Thursdays 1 to 4 p.m. and 7 to 9 p.m., Fridays 2 to 4 p.m. and 7 to 9 p.m. and Saturdays 1 to 5 p.m. Drop in anytime is Tuesdays at 10:30 a.m. There is always a lot of activity at the library!

What if one day you couldn't Walk?

Or maybe you couldn't speak clearly - Or your vision was blurred. That's what it's like to live with multiple sclerosis, an unpredictable disease of the central nervous system. Things you take for granted can become impossible and you don't know when or where or if it will strike again. But the research and services programs of the Multiple Sclerosis Society of Canada are providing some answers. With your help, we can connect with a cure. **1-800-268-7582** Multiple Sclerosis Society of Canada

If you know the whereabouts of
MS. TRACEY PILON
(Born: 1969),
please contact
CHRISTINE KEALY
at 1-613-264-1500 EXT. 317

The Annual Meeting
of the
**NORTH LANARK
AGRICULTURAL SOCIETY**
will be held on
TUESDAY, JANUARY 16, 2001
at 7:30 p.m.
in the Upstairs Hall
at the Community Centre.

All members are requested to attend
and refreshments will be served
after the meeting.

For info call Audrey at 256-2034

CONGRATULATIONS AND THANK YOU

PAKENHAM COMMUNITY HOME SUPPORT
would like to congratulate the winners of our
annual raffle for the UNITED WAY OF
LANARK COUNTY.

They are: 1st Prize - MARG FERGUSON;
2nd prize - DOREEN BLAIR;
3rd prize - BETH GILLAN.

Thank you to everyone who participated
by donating prizes and by selling and/or
purchasing tickets.

Myrna Blair
Interim Volunteer Coordinator

Church Directory

**Holy Name
of
Mary
Roman
Catholic
Church**



**St. Paul's
Anglican Church**

62 Clyde St.
Parish Office 256-1771
The Rev. Robert Davis
Organist: Isobel Kristjan
Praise Team: Mr. Steve Martin

WORSHIP

Sunday

8 a.m. - Quiet Traditional

9:15 a.m. - Choir & Organ

11 a.m. - Praise Team

*Sunday School and a Nursery
are offered during both the
9:15 and 11 o'clock Services,
between which we enjoy
coffee, juice and conversation
in the Parish Hall*

Wednesday

7 p.m. - Quiet Traditional

If you need a ride to church
please call the Parish Office.

**Almonte
United Church**

Minister: Rev. S. Derek Shelly

Director of Music:
Calvin Church

SUNDAY

10:30 a.m. Worship

and Sunday School,

and Child-Care

All Welcome!

e-mail:
auch@cyberus.ca

Dial-a-Prayer
256-1497

Office Hours:
Mon. - Fri.

9:00 a.m. - 2:00 p.m.
(256-1355)

For transportation
call 256-1355

**Cornerstone
Community Church**

Free Methodist Congregation

Pastor Glen Snider

SUNDAY

9:00 a.m. Sunday School

10:00 a.m. - Family Worship

Service

Kids Klub Wednesdays 7 p.m.

Sunday Evening Services

3rd Sunday every month at 6:30
p.m.

Prayer Meeting

Wednesday 7:00 p.m.

Corner of Hwy. 49 & Con. 11

256-4995 for information.

**Almonte
Baptist Church**

207 Reserve St.

256-5655

SUNDAY

Sunday School 9:45 a.m.

Morning Worship 11:00 a.m.

Thursday, after school,
KID'S FUN TIME.

All Welcome

**Almonte
Presbyterian
Church**

111 Church St. - 256-2184

Minister

Rev. James D. Ferrier, B.A.,
B.Th., M.Div.

Mr. George Stewart

Organist and Choir Director

SUNDAY

Adult Class 9:30 a.m.

Nursery Care 11:00 a.m.

Youth Class 11:00 a.m.

Children's Classes 11:15 a.m.

Morning Worship 11:00 a.m.

Everyone Welcome!

Let's Praise the Lord Together!

For information call the Church

Office Hours -

Monday to Thursday

9 a.m. to 12 p.m.

If transportation
is needed
call Elford Giles

256-2460

**Reformed
Presbyterian
Church**

273 Almonte St.

256-1749 for information

SUNDAY

Morning Worship - 10 a.m.

Bible Class - 11:15 a.m.

Rev. Matthew Dyck

Evening Worship - 6:30 p.m.

Wed. Bible Study - 7:30 p.m.

**Holy Name
of Mary
St. Mary's Parish**

Almonte 256-1034

Father W. Penney

SATURDAY MASS - 4:30 p.m.

SUNDAY MASS - 9 a.m. and
10:30 a.m.

ALMONTE AND DISTRICT ARTS COUNCIL PERFORMING ARTS

presents

Corey Cerovsek, violin Kai Gleusteen, violin
Nicolò Eugelmi, viola Stewart Goodyear, piano

Friday, January 12, 8:00 p.m.

(Piano Benefit Open Rehearsal)

Saturday, January 13, 8:00 p.m.

(Concert followed by supper party at Pinehurst)

ALMONTE OLD TOWN HALL

14 Bridge Street (Wheelchair Access)

Reservations / Information: 253-3353

www.adac.mississippimills.com

Tickets:

The Miller's Tale

The Music Store

87 Mill St., Almonte

26 Bridge St., Carleton Place

256-9090

257-2221

Adults \$20.00 • Students \$8.00 • Supper Party \$25.00

